LoopCasts

Orders, invoices and payments

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Handbook chapter 03

LOOPCASTS HANDBOOK · CHAPTER 03

Orders, invoices and payments

Internal handbook, chapter 3. Written by Lotte (orders, accounts) and Marieke (invoices, payments). Long chapter, sorry. This is where most of the week goes.

Part 1 — Orders (Lotte)

How an order comes in

A customer clicks "Order" on the website. That opens an e-mail to `orders@loopcasts.example`. The customer types what they want and sends it.

What we need: name, e-mail, product, and for companies the company name, address and VAT number. What we get: whatever the customer felt like typing. About one in three orders is missing something, mostly the VAT number or the address, so I mail back and wait. Some people never answer.

Some customers order by replying to the newsletter, or through `info@`, or they call Marieke. Those reach me sooner or later.

What I do with an order

1. Open `orders 2026.xlsx` in Dropbox (`ADMIN (new)`). If Marieke has it open, I get a "conflicted copy" later and have to merge by hand, so I first ask in the office whether anybody is in the file.
2. Add a row: date, name, e-mail, company, VAT number, country, product, price.
3. Move the mail to the Outlook folder "Orders – to invoice".
4. On Friday Marieke makes the invoices (part 2).
5. When the invoice is paid, Marieke tells me (or colours the row and I notice), and I create the account (part 3).

An order takes me about 5 minutes if it is complete, 15 if I have to mail back. I do this every morning first thing, around 35 a week.

I have an export of the sheet in `samples/orders-2026.csv` if you want to see what it looks like. It is the first two weeks of January, all orders, nothing left out. The colours do not survive an export, so I typed them in a column.

Part 2 — Invoices (Marieke)

Friday is invoice day. I block the morning.

Making an invoice

1. Open `Facturen 2026.xlsx` (the invoice register) and scroll to the bottom to find the last invoice number. The format is `2026-0001`, `2026-0002`, and so on. Numbers must be consecutive

without gaps: the accountant is strict about this.

2. Open `invoice template NEW.docx`. Not the one called `invoice template.docx`, that one still has our old address.
3. Type the customer details, the invoice number, the date, the product and the price.
4. Work out the VAT (see chapter 1 for the rules) and type the VAT amount and the total. I use the calculator on my phone.
5. For EU companies: check that there is a VAT number and add the line "VAT reverse charged". I do not check whether the number is valid, I would not know how.
6. Save as Word in `ADMIN (new)/Invoices 2026/` **and** "Save as PDF" in the same folder. File name: invoice number + customer name.
7. Add a row to the invoice register: number, date, customer, amount excl., VAT, total.
8. Mail the PDF to the customer from my own mailbox with our standard text (I have it in a draft and copy it).
9. Go back to the orders sheet and type the invoice number next to the order.

One invoice is about 8 minutes. With 30 to 35 on a Friday, that is my morning, and part of the afternoon in busy weeks.

Monthly subscribers get an invoice every month. There are about 210 of them. I do these on the first Friday of the month, and yes, that is a very long day. I copy last month's Word files and change the number and the date.

When it goes wrong

- In February Lotte helped with invoicing while I was recording. We both looked up the "last number" at the same moment. Two invoices went out with the same number. The accountant was not happy.
- Sometimes I type 21% on a reverse-charge invoice or the other way around. Customers usually tell us. Then I make a credit note, which is the same process again, twice.
- Once I sent the PDF of customer A to customer B. Same first name.

Payments

Customers pay by bank transfer. We ask them to put the invoice number in the message. About half do. The others write things like "loopcasts", their own order reference, or nothing.

On Friday afternoon I open the KBC app on my phone and go through the incoming payments of the week next to the invoice register on my laptop. When I find a match, **I colour the row green**. Green = paid. Orange = paid, but the amount was wrong. No colour = not paid yet. Lotte uses red in the orders sheet for "account created", do not mix them up.

Matching is detective work when the message is empty: I compare amounts and names. € 180.29 (yearly, with VAT) is a very common amount, so that does not help much.

This means a customer who pays on Monday waits until Friday evening, sometimes Monday, for their login. We get mails about this every week. For impatient customers I check the app in between, if I think of it.

Reminders

Once a month, roughly, I scroll through the register looking for rows without a colour that are older than 30 days, and I send those customers a friendly reminder. I write each one by hand because I want to check first whether they maybe did pay and I missed it. There are usually 15 to 20. I do not always get to it. At the moment I think about € 4,000 is open, but I would have to count.

Numbers for the accountant and for us

- Every quarter I zip all invoice PDFs and mail them to the accountant, together with the register. She retypes them into her system, as far as I know.
- Every month I want to know the revenue. I filter the register on month and add up the green rows. Excel cannot sum by colour (or I do not know how), so I select them by hand and look at the total at the bottom. Pieter once did the same for the same month and got a different number. We never found out why.

The register export is in `samples/invoice-register.csv` (same two weeks of January, plus one correction from the week after; the monthly subscribers are in another tab and not in the export).

Workshop quotes

Four to six times a year a company asks for a workshop on site. I have a call with them, think about the programme, and write a quote in Word. Every quote is different. This takes me two hours each, and I like doing it.

Part 3 — Customer accounts (Lotte)

When a row is green, the customer gets access.

1. Log in to phpMyAdmin at the host (login is in the passwords file).
2. Open the table `users` and click "Insert".
3. Fill in e-mail, a password that I make up (I use a pattern: first name + a number), the product and the end date.
4. The members script wants the password as an MD5 hash, so I pick "MD5" in the function dropdown. Jens showed me this. If you forget the dropdown, the login does not work.
5. Mail the customer their login and password with the welcome text (from a draft).
6. Colour the row in the orders sheet red (red = account created; I know it is confusing, I started with red before Marieke started with green).

About 5 minutes per account. For a team licence it is five accounts, and the customer mails the names separately, often weeks later, often one at a time.

When a subscription ends, I should set the account to inactive. See chapter 6 for how that goes in practice.